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Course: Digital Literacy (CSE0001)

PROJECT REPORT

Introduction

This report documents my work for the Digital Literacy (CSE0001) course at VIT Bhopal University. Taking on the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, I have developed a portfolio of resources designed to help my peers navigate the modern digital landscape. The project focuses on building a professional online identity, mastering collaborative tools, and practicing high-level cybersecurity hygiene. Each task in this report represents a core pillar of digital literacy essential for a successful academic and professional career.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For the first task, I had to create an infographic for creating awareness about digital literacy. I chose canva which is a popular, user-friendly online graphic design platform that allows users to create social media graphics, presentations, posters, documents, and other visual content. It is a very convenient and free to use tool to a great extent, you can easily get pre-made templates and objects along with assisting image generation which makes the graphic look more appealing.

I divided this infographic into 4-major parts or topics as to increase readability.
Firstly, **Digital literacy** which is ability to use digital devices effectively, Safely engaging in exchange of communication and financial transactions, Understanding use of different online platforms.

Secondly, **Online Security** which is Identifying common online risks such as Phishing, UPI fraud, and Identity Theft, Practicing "Stay Safe Online" habits, like using strong passwords and avoiding suspicious links, Knowing how to use official channels like the National Cyber Crime Portal (1930 helpline) if a fraud occurs.

Third, **Professional Presence** which tells to Establish professional profiles on Linkedin, GitHub, and Kaggle to showcase your education and specific learning goals, Post Precise and to-the-point content to connect better with others and to create a professional look use formal and easy to read language.

Fourth, **Email Etiquette** which tells to Master respectful, well-structured email formats. Write concise and to the point emails for better readability, Ensure the email includes proper subject-line and ensure proper grammar is used using Al-tools.

While creating this infographic, the most challenging part was to arrange all the points in order, be concise about it as the space was limited and making the format and the identation similar to other parts to make the infographic look neat and clean. Thankfully, Canva has different kind of measurement mark, shapes & elements and different kinds of tools to easily arrange information and graphics. I found it incredibly interesting how you can make such good and professional looking graphics on an online website that too for no cost.

Task 2 : Digital Portfolio

For Task 2, I built foundation professional over three very important platforms, GitHub, LinkedIn and Kaggle. Such platforms are not just option but essential to build a good foundation in tech based career

GitHub is a industry-standard platform for version control and collaborative software development.

I plan to use this repository as a living portfolio for my technical work. Over the next few years, I will host my Python scripts, contribute to open-source projects, and document my progress in cybersecurity

LinkedIn is a professional networking site designed for career development, recruitment, and building industry connections.

By maintaining an updated profile with my education at VIT Bhopal, I aim to connect with alumni and industry leaders. My goal is to leverage these connections to discover internship opportunities and stay informed about emerging trends in the tech sector.

Kaggle is a specialized community for data science and machine learning, providing access to datasets, cloud-based notebooks, and global competitions.

I intend to use Kaggle as a practical learning environment. I will participate in beginner-friendly competitions and use their datasets to practice building predictive models, which will complement my academic studies.

Task 3: Collaboration

- **Part A**: Technical Skill BuildingPlatform Used: HackerRank.Activity Description: I engaged with the HackerRank platform to complete a foundational Python introductory challenge. This exercise was designed to build my comfort level with browser-based IDEs and basic algorithmic logic & essential skills for any student in a technical branch.

Evidence of Completion: screenshot of the successful test case results and completion badge, titled hackerrank-completion.png, is included in the task-3-platforms/ folder.

- **Part B**: Collaborative Digital OutreachPlatforms Used: Google Forms & Google Sheets.Activity Description: Acting as a Student Digital Ambassador, I developed a 5-question "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" for my peers. The quiz uses a mix of multiple-choice and short-answer questions to test knowledge on critical digital safety topics, such as UPI transaction security, the risks of public Wi-Fi, and the official 1930 reporting helpline.

Live Form Access: https://forms.gle/KrVwCpwovdHHoKsV6

Documentation: Screenshots showing the design of the form and the backend response sheet are stored in the task-3-platforms/folder.

Task 4: Professional Email and Etiquette

The fourth task involved drafting formal emails for common academic and professional scenarios. While drafting these, I realized how easily poor digital communication can lead to significant problems. For example, a student might send a casual, poorly structured message to a professor regarding a missed deadline. Without a clear subject line or a formal greeting, the email could be ignored or misunderstood, resulting in a lost grade.

I found that using a clear structure—including a formal salutation and a concise explanation—prevents these misunderstandings. In my own drafts for an extension request and an internship inquiry, I prioritized clarity and respect over length. This task highlighted that professional etiquette is not just about being polite; it is about ensuring your message is taken seriously. I also developed a "Social Media Do’s and Don’ts" checklist to help maintain a clean digital footprint, which is vital in the cybersecurity field.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness and Prevention

For the final task, I researched a case study on **UPI and financial fraud**, which is a growing threat in India. I analyzed how scammers use "reverse payment" tactics to trick people into entering their UPI PINs to "receive" money. What surprised me most was how these attacks rely on social engineering rather than technical hacking. It was eye-opening to see that even tech-savvy students can be victims if they do not understand the basic logic that a PIN is only for sending money.

Through this research, I have changed my own digital habits, such as being much more skeptical of QR codes sent over WhatsApp. I also developed an 8-point prevention guide that emphasizes the importance of the **1930 national helpline** and the official **cybercrime.gov.in** portal. As a cybersecurity student, this task reinforced that human awareness is often the strongest layer of defense against digital crime.

Conclusion

Completing this project has greatly helped me realize the significance of being digitally literate in a professional capacity. A significant part of this realization came from the practical knowledge I gained by exploring these platforms and creating profiles on them. Doing so helped me realize how a digital portfolio is created from the ground up. Another significant part of this realization came from the knowledge I gained about how to effectively communicate and share information in a shared space by utilizing tools such as Canva and Google Workspace for data gathering.

However, taking it a step further than basic tool knowledge, I have come to realize the significance of having a professional online presence and the dire need for cybersecurity awareness. The most significant knowledge I gained throughout this project is about the official reporting mechanisms in India via the 1930 helpline, which I will now actively promote among my peers. I have gained a solid foundation for my B. Tech and future career in digital forensics thanks to this course.

Reference Links

Vityarthi Portal: https://www.vityarthi.com/

National Cyber Crime Portal: https://cybercrime.gov.in/Webform/Accept.aspx

Canva: Visual Suite for Everyone

GitHub: Where the world builds software

HackerRank: Technical Skills Platform

Project GitHUB Link: https://github.com/adhyansh25bcy10240-dot/digital-literacy-project/blob/main/task-1-presentation/infographic-desciption.md